

Segment 19 – Elliott Donnelley Wilderness

(Formerly Segment #18), updated April 2024 [Google Map of Segment 19](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

Trail Adopters: Jenny & Chris Engstrom (906)553-9974 or (906)360-9876, Ecjstrom@charter.net

Segment length: About 2.7 miles, east to west 201 ft of ascent, 74 ft of descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) Use Map # 41 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact the Trail Crew Leader (Bob Weisenberger, 906 361-4033, rweisenber@gmail.com) or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (for this segment, the trail description will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound.)

The Elliott Donnelley Wilderness was gifted to the State of Michigan on behalf of Trout Unlimited. This segment is a local favorite for hiking and snowshoeing.

The segment begins at the parking area for the Elliott Donnelley Wilderness (46.674126, -87.543066)

From the parking lot head southwest into the woods following the Little Garlic River, coming out on [Harrison Rd/Little Garlic Rd] at (46.660299, -87.567364).

Driving Directions:

Eastern Trailhead

From the corner of Hawley St./Lakeshore Boulevard in Marquette, head west for about 11 miles on Hawley St., which turns into [County Road (CR) 550/Big Bay Rd] to the Elliott Donnelley Wilderness parking area on the north side of the Little Garlic River.

Western Trailhead

From the corner of Hawley St./Lakeshore Boulevard in Marquette, head west on Hawley St., which turns into [County Road (CR) 550/Big Bay Rd] for a little over 11 miles. Pass the Little Garlic River and the Elliott Donnelley Wilderness parking area and take the first left onto [Harrison Rd/Little Garlic Rd]. Follow this road for about 1.6 miles to a parking area on the left. For those who prefer a Google Map, here is [Driving Map from CR 550 to Harrison Rd Parking](#). Please note, map does not include route from Marquette to Elliott Donnelley.

Camping:

This is a State of Michigan designated wilderness area. Per the Michigan DNR, dispersed camping is allowed with a backcountry permit. Contact [Van Riper State Park](#) for further information. There is an established campsite with a latrine on the east side of [Harrison Rd/Little Garlic Rd] along the Little Garlic Falls Spur.

Water Access:

Water is available via the Little Garlic River.

Seasonal Access Information:

CR 550 is drivable via vehicle year-round. The Elliott Donnelley Wilderness parking area is not maintained during winter months. There may be limited parking available at a pull off at the turn to Harrison Rd (46.674523, -87.545260). Your wintertime parking option may be along CR 550, which is a busy road.

An AWD vehicle is recommended to access the western trailhead parking near the Little Garlic bridge on [Harrison Rd/Little Garlic Rd] in the wintertime.